

1947, November 7

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed original by the
Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

SAINT FELIX MONASTERY. HUNTINGTON INDIANA.

November 7th 1947.

V. Sister Mary Cecilia.

Mount Saint Joseph, Ohio.

Dear Sister Mary Cecilia: God bless you and all your community at S.Jos's.

I recieved your very interesting letter several weeks ago and started a number of times to enroll your little "hopless case" in the Seraphic Mass Association; and each time I found no name to record. Consequently postponed further action.

Now I am going to give you a few particulars about that notable case that you probably never heard. Then you will easily conclude something as to what I would suggest and advise.

It was Saturday Morning January 10th 1925 that a neighbor-friend of theirs from Port Huron, brought your dear Parents to the St. Bonaventure Monastery in Detroit. Your poor Father was hardly able to talk. He tried, however, to tell briefly how he felt and that the doctors said he had "ulcers of the stomach". Later on I learned that they had sent him home as a hopeless case of cancer. I told him quite a little about the Ser-- Mass Association and suggested that he do something for the missions.

"Now I have you name Mr. Eagen." I said. "And you can enroll perpetually if you wish. If you are anyway short, however, I would advise that you enroll for just a year now and promise a perpetual enrollment as soon as convenient, if things go favorably." With a feeble quivering voice he answered: "I sure will." I took him to be 75 years old or upwards; Your poor Mother looked old too. Sunday morning eight days later your Father dove his own car down to keep his promise. From their appearance alone I would hardly have known them; but themoment he spoke I thought: "This is the fellow from Port Huron!" He looked thirty years younger. He was only thirty-nine at the time. "But Father"; he said, "The doctors in Pt. Huron want to take an exray ... What do you think?" I asked him : "How much is it going to cost you?" "...\$25." "What do you think?" I asked your smiling Mother. They were bothe smiling all over. "Father, he don't need it. Look at him!" she exclaimed. "Listen." I said. "You make a promise to the poor souls in Purgatory, that if you are able to forget that apointment tomorrow, you'll enroll them for a part of it." "Gee!" he said, "I'll give them half of it. I'll go them fifty-fifty."